

Undergraduate Nursing

Critical Care Nursing Study Pack

CharaNas Nursing — Specialty Notes

Expanded notes with original schematic figures for revision. These are educational drawings inspired by standard undergraduate teaching themes, not copied textbook plates. Always follow your faculty curriculum and latest guidelines.

Section	Focus
1	Core concepts in Critical Care Nursing
2	Assessment and early warning
3	Interventions and evaluation
4	Safety, teaching and teamwork
5	Checklist and book anchors
6	Quick pearls from these notes
7	Recommended book sources

1. Core concepts in Critical Care Nursing

High-yield undergraduate themes in critical care nursing for exams and clinical practice.

Connect assessment → priority → intervention → reassessment.

Patient safety, communication, and ethics are woven into every specialty.

Figure: Shock nursing priorities



Identify type (hypovolemic / distributive / cardiogenic / obstructive)

Trend MAP, mentation, urine output, lactate as available

Schematic figure for learning — verify details in your recommended textbooks.

Revision prompts

- Explain this section aloud in 60 seconds as if teaching a junior student about critical care nursing.
- List 3 red flags that would make you escalate care urgently.
- Name 2 investigations and 2 initial management steps you would consider first.

2. Assessment and early warning

Recognize red-flag presentations early in critical care nursing.

Use systematic ABC/safety frameworks before task lists.

Know when to call rapid response or escalate up the chain of command.

Revision prompts

- Explain this section aloud in 60 seconds as if teaching a junior student about critical care nursing.
- List 3 red flags that would make you escalate care urgently.
- Name 2 investigations and 2 initial management steps you would consider first.

3. Interventions and evaluation

Nursing actions should be evidence-informed and protocol-aligned.

Reassess after medications, oxygen, fluids, and teaching.

Document clearly; hand off risks using structured tools (SBAR themes).

Figure: Shock nursing priorities



Identify type (hypovolemic / distributive / cardiogenic / obstructive)

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Schematic figure for learning — verify details in your recommended textbooks.

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- Explain this section aloud in 60 seconds as if teaching a junior student about critical care nursing.
- List 3 red flags that would make you escalate care urgently.
- Name 2 investigations and 2 initial management steps you would consider first.

4. Safety, teaching and teamwork

Infection control, medication safety, and fall prevention are daily work.

Teach patients/families in plain language and verify understanding.

Collaborate with the interprofessional team; advocate when plans are unsafe.

Revision prompts

- Explain this section aloud in 60 seconds as if teaching a junior student about critical care nursing.
- List 3 red flags that would make you escalate care urgently.
- Name 2 investigations and 2 initial management steps you would consider first.

5. Checklist and book anchors

Checklist: ABC/safety → focused assessment → intervene → reassess → communicate.

After reading, practice with the MCQs and cases for active recall.

Primary references: Urden; AACN essentials.

Revision prompts

- Explain this section aloud in 60 seconds as if teaching a junior student about critical care nursing.
- List 3 red flags that would make you escalate care urgently.
- Name 2 investigations and 2 initial management steps you would consider first.

6. Quick pearls

High-yield reminders packaged with this specialty in CharaNas:

1. Treat the patient, not only the alarm (DOPE for vents).
2. Shock: ABC, access, oxygen, protocolized care.
3. Lung-protective ventilation themes in ARDS.
4. Neuro: ICP precautions and clustering care wisely.
5. High-alert drips need careful titration and double-checks.
 - Link symptoms → anatomy/physiology → investigation → first management step.
 - Write one OSCE-style explanation for a common presentation in this specialty.
 - After reading, do the Short MCQ and Case-based Question for active recall.

7. Recommended book sources

Standard undergraduate references commonly used internationally. Use the edition your college recommends. Figures in commercial textbooks are copyrighted; use library/licensed access for full plates and photographs.

#	Reference
1	Critical Care Nursing — Urden
2	AACN Essentials of Critical Care Nursing
3	ACLS/PALS references

How to study with this PDF: read one section → sketch the figure from memory → answer the MCQs/cases → review mistakes → revisit the matching section.

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